“The Planning Commission will—

(i) Make an assessment of the material, capital and human resources of the country, including technical personnel, and investigate the possibilities of augmenting such of those resources as are found to be deficient in relation to the nation’s requirements;

(ii) Formulate a plan for the most effective and balanced utilisation of the country’s resources;

(iii) On a determination of priorities, define the stages in which the plan should be carried out and propose the allocation of resources for the due completion of each stage;

(iv) Indicate the factors which are tending to retard economic development, and determine the conditions which, in view of the current social and political situation, should be established for the successful execution of the plan;

(v) Determine the nature of the machinery which will be necessary for securing the successful implementation of each stage of the plan in all its aspects;

(vi) Appraise from time to time the progress achieved in the execution of each stage of the Plan and recommend the adjustments of policy and measures that such appraisal may show to be necessary; and

(vii) Make such interim or ancillary recommendations as appear to be appropriate either for facilitating the discharge of the duties assigned to it; or on a consideration of the prevailing economic conditions, current policies, measures and development programmes; or on an examination of such specific problems as may be referred to it for advice by Central or State Governments.”

With the commencement of the Tenth Plan (2002–07), the Government handed over ***two new functions*** to the planning commission in 2002, namely-

(i) To monitor the plan implementation with special reference to the process of ‘economic reforms’ with the help, of the steering committees.

It should be noted here that once the process of economic reforms was initiated in the country (early 1990s) there was a diminishing role proposed